in 1438 on the thrones of both Hungary and Germany.

He took the Hungarian capital city of Alba Regia for his home, and at first directed his energies against the Bohemians, who were refusing to recognize his kingship. The Castilian traveler Pero Tafur, visiting his headquarters during the first Christmas of his reign, found him at the Bohemian border city of Breslau with "a great army"; he was impressed by Albert II's courtesy ("honest in his bearing . . . an open and vigorous knight"), and even more astounded by the cold winter. "So cold is the city that [the king] and his courtiers go about in the streets seated in wooden vehicles like threshing machines," he marveled. "No one with any money rides on horseback for fear of falling, for the streets are like glass owing to the continual frosts. . . . It was so cold that my teeth almost fell out of my mouth."[2]



94.1 The Wars of Murad II

The Bohemians were not easily reduced, however, and in 1439 Albert II decided to turn southward against the Turkish front in Serbia. After an undistinguished campaign in which nothing particular happened, he was journeying back towards Vienna when he grew ill; he died at the Hungarian city of Neszmély on October 27, not quite finishing out two years as king of Hungary. He had never actually managed to be crowned king of Germany, and died as king-elect.

His venture against the Turks had produced one unexpected effect. In